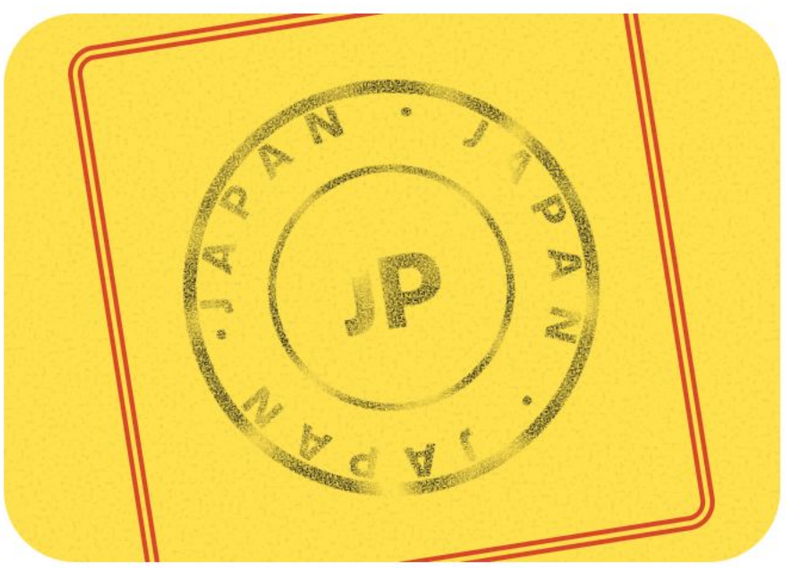
How foreign companies enter Japan

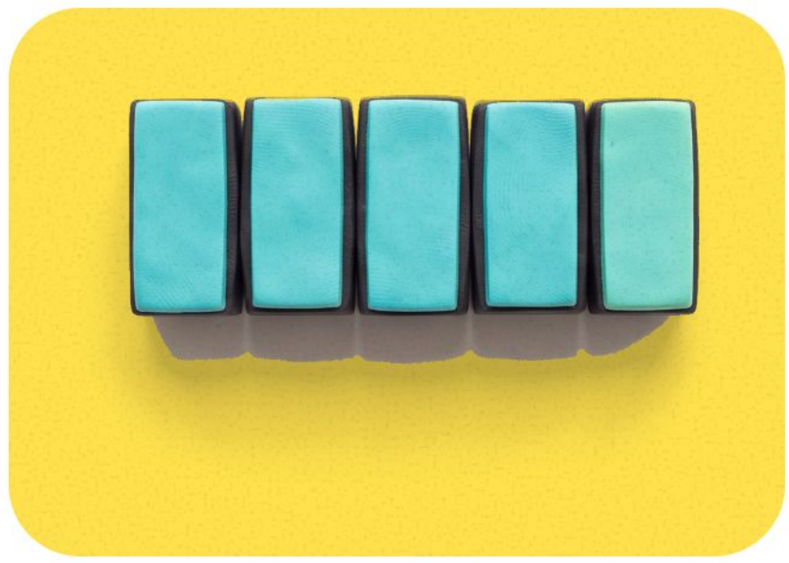




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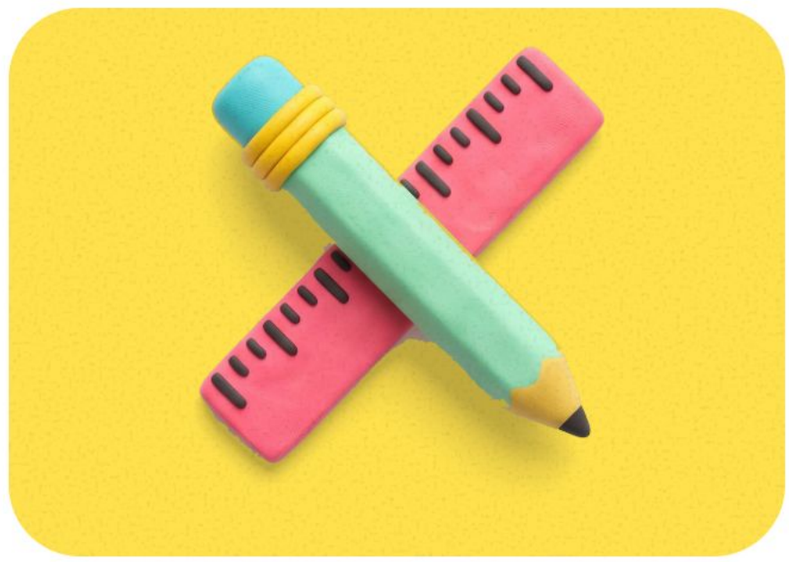
Four routes in



Route	Good for	Watch out
Distributor	Speed, relationships	Less control
Rep office	Research, liaison	No sales
Branch	Trading as the parent	Parent liable
KK · GK	Full presence	Cost, visa capital

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KK or GK?



GK

Cheaper to set up and run

KK

More weight with traditional clients

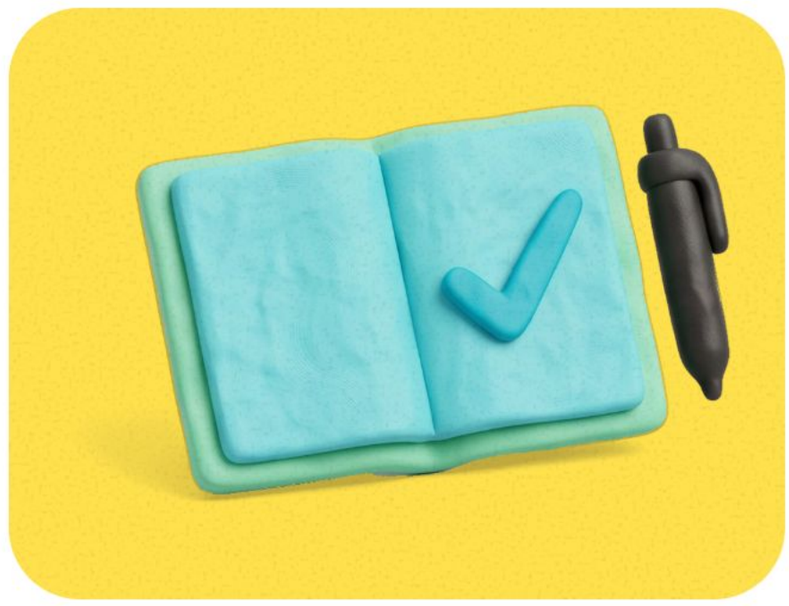
Both

No resident director needed since 2015

Source: 会社法 · 法務省

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Numbers to know



¥30m

Business Manager visa capital since October 2025

50 days

Free JETRO office space, in six cities

3

Big marketplaces to test on first

Source: 出入国在留管理庁 · JETRO IBSC

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Test online, then commit

Amazon Japan, Rakuten Ichiba and Yahoo Shopping show real demand.

Use the results to choose your entity and partners.

Marketplace

↓

Distributor

↓

Subsidiary



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Choose the route for the control you need now.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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